

Chapter 2: National and Regional Trends and Forecasts

County to County Commuter Flows

The Tri-Cities region is part of an interconnected metropolitan area that extends beyond its borders. Examining commuting patterns both within the region and beyond provides insight into the interconnectedness of the region's economy and the role of the transportation network in supporting those connections.

Table 3 summarizes county-to-county commuter flow data derived from 2025 StreetLight Origin-Destination traffic volumes (Average Daily Traffic) and Home-Based Work (HBW) trip purpose data. This 2025 traffic volume dataset covers all days of the week using default time periods, and includes the TCAMPO-area portions of Chesterfield, Dinwiddie, and Prince George Counties, along with the Cities of Colonial Heights, Hopewell, and Petersburg. External volumes were derived using Traffic Analysis Zones (TAZs), including zones outside the Tri-Cities Region from the RTC model, as well as other origin and destination trips outside the RTC model.

As shown in **Figure 18**, the share of Internal-Internal (I-I) trips that begin and end within TCAMPO varies considerably by jurisdiction, ranging from a high of 71.7 percent in Prince George to a low of 37.6 percent in Chesterfield. Prince George, Colonial Heights, Petersburg, and Hopewell have the greatest share of internal trips, with all but Hopewell retaining more than two-thirds of commute trips within the MPO. Prince George also has the highest proportion of trips that begin and end within the same jurisdiction (45.4 percent), reflecting the influence of Fort Gregg-Adams as a major local employer and trip generator.

In contrast, nearly two-thirds of commute trips associated with the TCAMPO portion of Chesterfield travel outside the MPO. Much of this travel is to destinations within the Richmond region, particularly the portions of Chesterfield County located within the Richmond Regional TPO, as well as Henrico and the City of Richmond. This pattern reflects the strong economic and commuting relationship between the Tri-Cities area and the greater Richmond metropolitan region.

Figure 18. Share of TCAMPO Trips Staying Within the Region, by Jurisdiction

Source: StreetLight, 2025

Among internal TCAMPO flows, the strongest connections are centered on Prince George and Petersburg (**Table 3**). Prince George exchanges the highest volume of trips with any other jurisdiction in the region, particularly with Petersburg (2,203 trips) and Hopewell (2,086 trips), reflecting its high levels of population and employment and its role as the geographic center between the region's urban cores. Chesterfield also shows a notable bidirectional relationship with Prince George, Colonial Heights, and Petersburg (approximately 600–700 trips in both directions), which is consistent with Chesterfield's overall size growing employment in both jurisdictions and Petersburg's role as an activity center for surrounding jurisdictions.

Table 3. Commute Flows within Tri-Cities Area MPO

		TCAMPO Destinations					
		Chesterfield	Colonial Heights	Dinwiddie	Hopewell	Petersburg	Prince George
TC A M P O O r i g i n s	Chesterfield	1,562	654	312	319	618	733
	Colonial Heights	606	1,850	263	271	506	684
	Dinwiddie	283	265	427	91	535	326
	Hopewell	312	321	101	2,036	319	1,052
	Petersburg	628	507	586	301	2,155	1,106
	Prince George	625	671	250	1,034	1,097	6,340

Source: StreetLight, 2025

